(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (d) Executive power of the Union of India is vested in the President of India. Cabinet Secretary is the ex-officio head of the Civil Services Board, the Cabinet Secretariat, the Indian Administrative Service (IAS) and head of all civil services under the rules of business of the Government of India.

• Legislature: Council of Ministers

34. When a bill is referred to a joint sitting of both the Houses of the Parliament, it has to be passed by
(a) a simple majority of members present and voting
(b) three-fourths majority of members present and voting
(c) two-thirds majority of the Houses
(d) absolute majority of the Houses

Ans : (a) Such a sitting is summoned by the president to settle a deadlock between the two houses on a bill. The bill is passed by a simple majority i.e. a majority of the number of members present and voting.

35. Consider the following statements :
1. The Legislative Council of a State in India can be larger in size than half of the Legislative Assembly of that particular State.
2. The Governor of a State nominates the Chairman of Legislative Council of that particular State.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (d) Under Article 171 (1) and Article 172 of the constitution, the Legislative council must not have more than a third of the total membership of the Assembly of the state, and in no case fewer than 40 members.

36. There is a Parliamentary System of Government in India because the
(a) Lok Sabha is elected directly by the people
(b) Parliament can amend the Constitution
(c) Rajya Sabha cannot be dissolved
(d) Council of Ministers is responsible to the Lok Sabha

Ans : (d) This is the bedrock principle of parliamentary government. The ministers are collectively responsible to the parliament in general and to the Lok Sabha in particular (Article 75).

• Judiciary (Union and State)

37. Who/Which of the following is the custodian of the Constitution of India?
(a) The President of India
(b) The Prime Minister of India
(c) The Lok Sabha Secretariat
(d) The Supreme Court of India

Ans : (d) The Supreme Court of India is the apex court in India. As stated by the Indian constitution, the function of the supreme court of India is that of the custodian of the constitution, a court established by the authority of a federal government and the uppermost court of appeal.

• Panchayati Raj System Constitution and Amendments and Schedules

38. The provision in Fifth Schedule and Sixth Schedule in the Constitution of India are made in order to –
(a) protect the interests of Scheduled Tribes
(b) determine the boundaries between States
(c) determine the powers, authority and responsibilities of Panchayats
(d) protect the interests of all the border States

Ans : (a) The fifth schedule of the constitution of India deals with the administration and control of scheduled areas and scheduled tribes in these areas. The sixth schedule to the constitution of India contains provisions concerning the administration of tribal areas in the states of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram.

39. The fundamental object of Panchayati Raj system is to ensure which among the following?
1. People's participation in development
2. Political accountability
3. Democratic decentralization
4. Financial mobilization

Select the correct answer using the code given below:
(a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 2 and 4 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans : (c) Article 243-B provides for a three-tier Panchayati Raj System in India. It is a system of self-government at the local level. The basic objective of this system is to enable the general public to participate in developmental administration and ensure democratic decentralization of power/governance.

ECONOMICS

• Economic Planning and National Income / Budget

40. A decrease in tax to GDP ratio of a country indicates which of the following?
1. Slowing economic growth rate
2. Less equitable distribution of national income

Select the correct answer using the code given below:
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (a) The tax-to-GDP is an economic measurement that compares the amount of taxes collected by a government to the amount of income that country receives for its products. That income is measured in terms of the gross domestic product or GDP, which is the sum of all products and goods sold, personal and government investment, and net exports. By comparing this amount to the amount that is collected in tax revenue, economists can get a rough idea of how much the economy of a specific government is fueled by its tax collection.

41. With reference to the Union Government, consider the following statements :
1. The Department of Revenue is responsible for the preparation of Union Budget that is presented to the Parliament.
2. No amount can be withdrawn from the Consolidated Fund of India without the authorization from the Parliament of India.
3. All the disbursements made from Public Account also need the authorization from the Parliament of India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans : (c) Department of Economic affairs prepares the Union Budget. Public Accounts includes provident fund deposits, judicial deposits, saving bank deposits, departmental deposits, remittances and so on. The payments from this account can be made without parliamentary appropriation. Such payments are mostly in the nature of banking transactions. So, only statement (2) is correct.

42. With reference to Indian economy, consider the following statements :
1. The rate of growth of Real Gross Domestic Product has steadily increased in the last decade.
2. The Gross Domestic Product at market prices (in rupees) has steadily increased in the last decade.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (b) Due to the recession in 2008 the growth rate of the Indian economy had declined for the next few years from 8-9% to 5-6%. So statement (1) is wrong. Even though the growth rate declined, it never became negative. So the GDP at market prices has always increased year on year for the last decade.

43. With reference to inflation in India, which of the following statements is correct?
(a) Controlling the inflation in India is the responsibility of the Government of India only
(b) The Reserve Bank of India has no role in controlling the inflation
(c) Decreased money circulation helps in controlling the inflation
(d) Increased money circulation helps in controlling the inflation

Ans : (c) Decreasing the money circulation decreases the demands of goods and services, which helps in controlling inflation. It is mainly effective for demand-pull inflation.

44. There has been a persistent deficit budget year after year. Which of the following actions can be taken by the government to reduce the deficit?
1. Reducing revenue expenditure
2. Introducing new welfare schemes
3. Rationalizing subsidies
4. Expanding industries

Select the correct answer using the code given below:
(a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans : (a) Budget deficit is used to define a status of financial health in which expenditures exceed revenue. Introducing a new welfare scheme and expanding industries by budgetary support will expand the budget expenditure, which will widen the deficit.
Rationalizing subsidies and reducing revenue expenditure are two direct ways of reducing the fiscal burden of the government of India.

• Agriculture, Industry and Trade

45. In the `Index of Eight Core Industries', which one of the following is given the highest weight?
(a) Coal production
(b) Electricity generation
(c) Fertilizer production
(d) Steel production

Ans : (b) Core industries account for 38% in IIP. Electricity with 10.3% has the highest weight among Core industries viz. Coal, Fertilizer, Electricity, Crude Oil, Natural Gas, Refinery Product, Steel and Cement.

46. In India, markets in agricultural products are regulated under the–
(a) Essential Commodities Act, 1955
(b) Agricultural Produce Market Committee Act enacted by States
(c) Agricultural Produce (Grading and Marking) Act, 1937
(d) Food Products Order, 1956 and Meat and Food Products Order, 1973

Ans : (b) In India, markets in agricultural products are regulated under the agricultural produce market committee act enacted by states.

47. Which of the following brings out the `Consumer Price Index Number for Industrial Workers'?
(a) The Reserve Bank of India
(b) The Department of Economic Affairs
(c) The Labour Bureau
(d) The Department of Personnel and Training

Ans : (c) The Labour Bureau brings out the Consumer Price Index Number for Industrial Workers.

48. The substitution of steel for wooden ploughs in agricultural production is an example of–
(a) labour-augmenting technological progress
(b) capital-augmenting technological progress
(c) capital-reducing technological progress
(d) None of the above

Ans : (b) Labour augmenting is the technology that increases skills and productivity of the existing labour force (example-teaching people how to use the computer). Capital augmenting technology increase the productivity of existing capital goods. In this case, replacement of wood with steel increases the productivity of the plough.